

CHOOSING THE BEST PROCESS AND FORM

Chapter 6

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- ◉ The significance of skillful writing
- ◉ The process of writing
- ◉ How to write letters
- ◉ How to write memorandums
- ◉ How to write e-mails

THE SIGNIFICANCE OF SKILLFUL WRITING

- ◉ Writing skill appears ahead of other communication skills
- ◉ Strong writing skill is required in order to get the promotion
- ◉ Writing is relatively more difficult than other sorts of communication
- ◉ Capturing a complex reality by putting one word after another requires ingenuity and discipline.

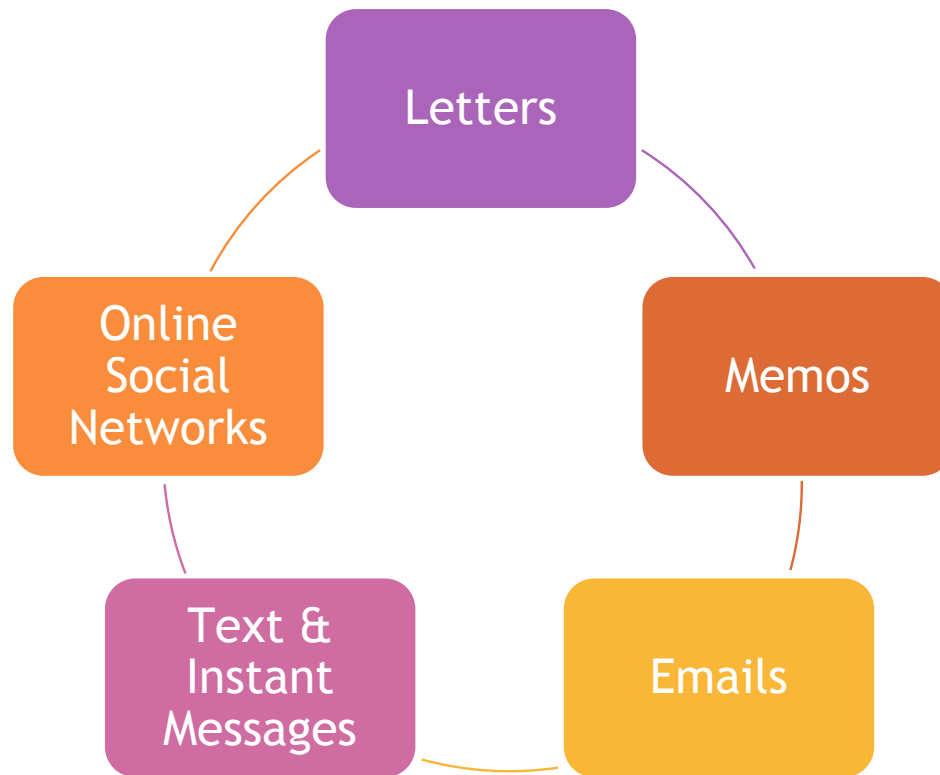
THE PROCESS OF WRITING



THE PROCESS OF WRITING (CONT.)

- ◉ The three stages are not strictly chronological or separate
- ◉ Blend the stages as necessary
- ◉ Spend a third of your writing time in each of the stage.
- ◉ Make the format easily readable for your reader.
- ◉ The writer is responsible for making the important formatting decision.

MAIN TYPES OF BUSINESS MESSAGES



LETTERS

- ◉ Letters are the oldest form of communication.
- ◉ Previous letters focused more on techniques of courtesy.
- ◉ Current emphasis is on strategy and humanness.

BUSINESS LETTER TEMPLATE

Date: Use month, day, year format, e.g., March 3, 2012 or 3 March 2012

Sender's Address: It is a good idea to include sender's email and url, if available. Don't include this information if it's already incorporated into the letterhead design. This will allow customers to find your small business more quickly.

Inside Address: Use full name. Mr./Miss/Mrs./Ms. is optional

Salutation: Dear Mr. Andrew. Be sure to use a colon at the end of the name, not a comma as in personal letters

BUSINESS LETTER TEMPLATE (CONT.)

Body Text: State why you are writing.

Establish any connection/mutual relationship up front. Outline the solution, providing proof in the way of examples and expert opinions. Group related information into paragraphs

Closing "Call to Action": State what the reader needs to do and what you will do to follow up

Signature Block: Sign your letter in blue or black ink

Enclosures: Use if you have an enclosure

316 Colonial Pkwy
Esterhazy, NM 87101

July 30, 2017

Ms. Ginny Clark
Overwatch Villa
7419 Bubble Net Road
Baleen, WA 98101

Dear Ms. Clark:

Hope you're doing well. I'm Miranda Lawson, Director of Marketing at Mass Airlines, and I wanted to share some marketing ideas with you that could benefit both of our companies.

Whenever our flight crews fly into the Seattle area, they overwhelmingly prefer staying at the Overwatch Villa, but there is often no vacancy. If the Overwatch Villa were to permanently reserve a block of rooms for our crew members, we'd be happy to promote the Overwatch Villa in our in-flight magazine at a significant discount.

To demonstrate what a Mass Airlines and Overwatch Villa partnership could look like, I've enclosed three sample ads created by our graphic design team. These samples should prove that we're eager to highlight the Overwatch Villa for the millions of passengers we serve each year. If you'd like to discuss this in further detail, I can be reached at 575-555-9255, or at mlawson@massairlines.com. I look forward to hearing from you.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink that reads "Miranda Lawson". The script is fluid and cursive, with the first name and last name clearly distinguishable.

Miranda Lawson
Director of Marketing, Mass Airlines

Enclosures: Three samples of print advertisements.

MEMORANDUMS

- ◉ Memos are internal letters.
- ◉ It is used as a short proposal. Should not exceed one page.
- ◉ Memos are sent to co-workers and colleagues.
- ◉ They are more informal and do not require a closure statement like business messages.
- ◉ Do not use memos for a lot of information. Some memos may be classified as reports.
- ◉ Some large companies have additional headings.

MEMO FORMAT: SAMPLE

Memo: sometimes the word Memo appears at the top

TO: recipients' names and job titles

FROM: writer's name and job title

DATE:

SUBJECT: description of what the memo is about.

First sentence: reason for the memo.

Second sentence: any instructions or information.

Closing sentence: what is required of the reader
(confirmation, answers or feedback)

(message should be single spaced)

MEMO FORMAT

Company Name Here

Memo

To: [Click here and type name]

From: [Click here and type name]

CC: [Click here and type name]

Date: 7/2/01

Re: [Click here and type subject]

Word Automatically inserts today's date.

How to Use This Memo Template

Select text you would like to replace, and type your memo. Use styles such as Heading 1-3 and Body Text in the Style control on the Formatting toolbar. To save changes to this template for future use.

Type your text here.

EMAIL

- ⦿ Explosive recent growth
- ⦿ And the growth to continue
- ⦿ Make sure you have a formal and neutral e-mail addresses, ideally consisted of first and last name

TERRIBLE E-MAIL ADDRESSES

- ◉ Brokenheart.hridoy@gmail.com
- ◉ Sweetgirl.samina@gmail.com
- ◉ Rudestgirl007@gmail.com
- ◉ DavidAtHotmailDotComIMeanYahooDotCom@yahoo.com
- ◉ Santacloss_6@yahoo.com
- ◉ kingofleon1987@hotmail.com

STRUCTURE OF EMAIL

- ◉ Standardized elements

- To
- Cc
- Bcc
- Subject
- Attachments
- Salutation
- Message (opening, main body, call to action)
- Closing

MISTAKES PEOPLE MAKE IN EMAIL SUBJECT LINES

- ◉ Not writing one
- ◉ Writing too much (More than 6-8 words)
- ◉ Being too vague (do you have a sec?)
 - Be clear and specific
- ◉ Not to place the important element
- ◉ Using filler words (hello, thanks)
- ◉ Putting words in ALL CAPS
- ◉ Using the wrong name
- ◉ Using illogical words

FORMALITY OF EMAIL WRITING

- Range is from highly formal to highly informal.
- Three general writing styles:
 - Casual
 - Informal
 - Formal

CASUAL WRITING—ACCEPTABLE BETWEEN ACQUAINTANCES

- ◎ Personal contractions, personal pronouns, incomplete sentences, initials and highly informal
- Example:
 - “Hi Smith buddy! Read your super proposal. IMHO, it’s in the bank”.*

INFORMAL WRITING

- ◉ Retains some casual qualities (personal pronouns, contractions)
- ◉ Polished conversation and organized sentences
- ◉ Corresponds to proper conversation
- Example: *“I’ve read your excellent proposal. I predict the administrators will approve it.”*

FORMAL WRITING

- ◉ Maintains distance between writer and reader.
- ◉ Avoids personal references and contractions.
- Example: “*The proposal is excellent. The executives are likely to approve it.*”

GENERAL EMAIL WRITING CONSIDERATIONS

Conciseness

- Make the sentences short—only the essentials.
- Use words economically.
- Paraphrase previous messages concisely.
- Quote selectively.

THANK YOU